

Nielsen Norman Group **Heuristic Evaluation Workbook**

Use this workbook to conduct your own heuristic evaluation.

For each of Jakob's 10 Usability Heuristics, look for specific places where the interface fails to adhere to the guideline. Write your recommendations for how to fix those usability issues.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

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PRODUCT: Garbage Truck Tracker

TASK:

1

Visibility of System Status

The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time.

- Does the design clearly communicate its state?
- Is feedback presented quickly after user actions?

Issues

The map view lacks clear indicators of where the truck is in real-time, which might lead to uncertainty.

Recommendations

Integrate a live GPS icon for the truck on the map so users can see its actual proximity rather than just a distance number.

2

Match Between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than internal jargon. Follow real-world conventions, making information appear in a natural and logical order.

- Will user be familiar with the terminology used in the design?
- Do the design's controls follow real-world conventions?

Issues

None. The flow from location setup to schedule is logical.

Recommendations

Maintain the use of localized icons for different types of waste (recyclable vs. residual) to further align with local sorting habits.

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3

User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without having to go through an extended process.

- Does the design allow users to go back a step in the process?
- Are exit links easily discoverable?
- Can users easily cancel an action?
- Is *Undo* and *Redo* supported?

Issues

In the "Report an Issue" or "Location Setup" flows, there isn't always a prominent "Back" button visible, which could trap a user if they make a mistake.

Recommendations

Ensure a consistent "Back" arrow is present in the top-left corner of all sub-menus to allow users to exit unwanted actions easily.

4

Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. Follow platform and industry conventions.

- Does the design follow industry conventions?
- Are visual treatments used consistently throughout the design?

Issues

Mixed icon sets make the app feel "stitched together" rather than a single cohesive product.

Recommendations

Use a unified icon library. If the dashboard uses "filled" icons, the settings menu should also use "filled" icons to maintain a professional look.

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5

Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully prevent problems from occurring in the first place. Either eliminate error-prone conditions, or check for them and present users with a confirmation option before they commit to the action.

- Does the design prevent slips by using helpful constraints?
- Does the design warn users before they perform risky actions?

Issues

There is a confirmation dialog for "Delete Account", which is a great preventative measure for risky actions.

Recommendations

Add a confirmation prompt before a user submits a "Report Issue" to ensure they didn't click it by accident.

6

Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another. Information required to use the design (e.g. field labels or menu items) should be visible or easily retrievable when needed.

- Does the design keep important information visible, so that users do not have to memorize it?
- Does the design offer help in-context?

Issues

The "Eco Truck Tips" is a long list. Users might forget the tips once they leave that screen.

Recommendations

Use "in-context" tips. For example, show a small "Don't forget to segregate" tip on the collection day notification itself.

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7

Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts — hidden from novice users — may speed up the interaction for the expert user such that the design can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users. Allow users to tailor frequent actions.

- Does the design provide accelerators like keyboard shortcuts and touch gestures?
- Is content and functionality personalized or customized for individual users?

Issues

There are no apparent "shortcuts" for power users, such as a one-tap "Report Missed Collection" button on the home screen.

Recommendations

Add a floating action button on the map or dashboard for "Quick Report" to speed up the reporting process for frequent issues.

8

Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information that is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information in an interface competes with the relevant units of information and diminishes their relative visibility.

- Is the visual design and content focused on the essentials?
- Have all distracting, unnecessary elements been removed?

Issues

The footer area in the "More" section contains a lot of dense text (Terms and Conditions, Company Info) that could be moved to a separate "About" page to reduce visual noise.

Recommendations

Use "Read More" toggles for legal text to keep the interface clean and focused on user actions.

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9

Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

- Does the design use traditional error message visuals, like bold, red text?
- Does the design offer a solution that solves the error immediately?

Issues

If a "Report Issue" fails to send due to connection, it's unclear if the app provides a constructive error message.

Recommendations

If a submission fails, provide a "Save as Draft" or "Retry" button instead of just a generic "Error" alert.

10

Help and Documentation

It's best if the system doesn't need any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users understand how to complete their tasks.

- Is help documentation easy to search?
- Is help provided in context right at the moment when the user requires it?

Issues

There is no dedicated "FAQ" or search bar for help topics.

Recommendations

Add a searchable "Help Center" within the "More" tab to help users find answers to specific questions like "What the garbage thrown up?"